

Compiler Simulator Web

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MINI LAB PROJECT REPORT

This Report Presented in Partial Fulfillment of the
course **CSE314: Compiler Design Lab** in the
Computer Science and Engineering Department



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DECLARATION

We hereby declare that this lab project has been done by us under the supervision of **Rabeya Khatun, Lecturer, Department of Computer Science and Engineering, Daffodil International University**. We also declare that neither this project nor any part of this project has been submitted elsewhere as lab projects.

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COURSE & PROGRAM OUTCOME

The following course outcomes are achieved through the successful design and implementation of the **CompilerSimulatorWeb** project. This project demonstrates the practical application of compiler construction concepts through a web-based interactive compiler simulation system.

Table 1: Course Outcome Statements

CO's	Statements
CO1	Understand the complete working procedure of a compiler by simulating all major compilation phases including lexical, syntax, semantic analysis, intermediate code generation, optimization, and assembly code generation.
CO2	Analyze the role of syntax rules, semantic checks, and type validation in programming languages through parse trees, semantic trees, and symbol tables.
CO3	Apply compiler construction techniques, algorithms, and tools to design and implement individual compiler phases using C for backend processing and web technologies for visualization.
CO4	Create a complete compiler simulation project and effectively communicate complex computer engineering activities through interactive demonstrations, visualization, and technical documentation.

Table 2: Mapping of CO, PO, Blooms, KP, Complex Engineering Problem (CEP) and Complex Engineering Activity (CEA)

CO	PO	Blooms	KP	CEP	CEA
CO1	PO1	C1, C2	K1–K4	EP1	
CO2	PO2	C3, C4	K1–K4, K6	EP1, EP3	
CO3	PO3	C4, A2	K6	EP1, EP3	
CO4	PO10	C6, P3, A2	K4	EP3, EP5	EA3

The mapping justification for the above table is explained in detail in **Section 4.3.1 (Mapping of Program Outcomes)**, **Section 4.3.2 (Complex Problem Solving)**, and **Section 4.3.3 (Complex Engineering Activities)**.

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Chapter 1

Introduction

This chapter presents an overview of our project “**CompilerSimulatorWeb – Stepwise Learning Tool for Compiler Phases.**” It introduces the background of the project, the motivation behind building an interactive compiler learning platform, the key objectives, and the expected outcomes. The chapter also includes a feasibility analysis, gap identification, and the significance of the system in the context of modern compiler education.

1.1 Introduction

The **CompilerSimulatorWeb** project is a web-based educational platform designed to visually demonstrate how different phases of a compiler work internally when processing arithmetic expressions. Traditional compiler courses primarily rely on theoretical explanations and textbook diagrams, which makes it difficult for students to understand how an actual compiler transforms an input expression into optimized intermediate code and ultimately produces assembly-like output. The lack of visualization often makes the subject abstract, especially for beginners who are encountering compiler design for the first time.

Our project addresses this problem by implementing a **step-by-step visual simulation** of six major compiler phases: **Lexical Analysis**, **Syntax Analysis**, **Semantic Analysis**, **Intermediate Code Generation**, **Code Optimization**, and **Assembly Code Generation**. When the user provides an input arithmetic expression through the browser interface, the system processes that expression in the backend and produces clear, structured outputs for each compiler phase. These outputs include tokens, symbol tables, normalized expressions, variable mapping tables, parse-tree-style visual graphs, semantic structures, three-address code, optimized code, and assembly-like instructions.

The primary aim is to transform complex compiler behavior into an interactive and easily understandable visual experience. Instead of reading long theories about how a compiler works internally, learners can directly observe how each phase modifies the expression and passes the result to the next stage. This makes compiler education more intuitive, practical, and engaging.

1.2 Motivation

The motivation for developing **CompilerSimulatorWeb** stems from the consistent challenges students face while learning compiler design. Compiler construction involves multiple abstract concepts—tokenization, parsing, semantic validation, intermediate code forms, optimization rules—most of which remain invisible when using a traditional compiler. Students only see the final compiled output, not the internal steps. This leads to several academic and conceptual problems:

1. Abstract Compiler Concepts are Hard to Visualize

Students struggle to understand how raw input transforms into tokens, how parse trees are generated from grammar rules, and how expressions convert into optimized intermediate code. Without visualization, these steps feel disconnected and difficult to imagine.

2. Limited Debugging Insight

In real compilers, errors often appear as cryptic messages. Beginners find it challenging to understand which compiler phase produced the error and why. A visual breakdown of each step reduces confusion and enhances learning.

3. Lack of Integrated Learning Tools

Existing tools usually focus on one phase—only lexical analysis, only parsing, or only code generation. There are very few tools that visually integrate the entire pipeline in a unified system.

4. Need for More Interactive, Web-Based Platforms

Most available compiler learning tools are outdated desktop applications. Modern students prefer browser-based environments that do not require installation and can run on any device.

Therefore, our motivation is both **educational** and **technological**:

To build a fully integrated, interactive, web-based compiler learning system that makes compiler education accessible, visual, and engaging for beginners.

1.3 Objectives

The **primary objectives** of the CompilerSimulatorWeb project include:

1. **Develop a Modern Web Interface:**
Create a clean, intuitive browser-based platform using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript where users can enter expressions and view compiler outputs.
2. **Implement a Full Compilation Pipeline:**
Simulate all major compiler phases—lexical, syntax, semantic, intermediate code generation, optimization, and assembly code generation.
3. **Provide Step-by-Step Visualization:**
Display real-time transformations to help students observe how each compiler phase processes the input.
4. **Ensure Automatic Data Flow Across Phases:**
A single input expression should automatically propagate through all compiler modules, ensuring consistency and reducing user effort.
5. **Educational Integration:**
Include short theory explanations inside each phase to teach concepts alongside visual outputs.
6. **Error Visualization:**
Provide meaningful, easy-to-understand error messages pointing to the exact compiler phase that caused the issue.
7. **Scalability & Performance:**
Ensure the system handles different types and complexities of arithmetic expressions efficiently.

These objectives align with the broader goal of transforming compiler education into a smoother and more interactive learning experience.

1.4 Feasibility Study

a. Technical Feasibility

Our project is technically feasible due to the use of reliable and modern technologies:

- **Frontend:** HTML, CSS, and JavaScript provide a lightweight, user-friendly interface.
- **Backend:** Node.js and Express.js offer fast processing with modular architecture suitable for compiler logic simulation.
- **Visualization:** JavaScript functions and structured data outputs help generate clear visual representations of tokens, parse structures, and intermediate code.
- **Local Execution:** The system can run on any standard computer without installing heavy compilers or IDEs.

These tools are mature, well-documented, and widely supported, ensuring long-term stability and ease of further development.

b. Similar Research and Tools

Several compiler visualization tools and research projects inspired our design:

1. **ANTLR Visualizers:** Useful for grammar debugging but limited in full pipeline visualization.
2. **Online Compiler Explorers:** Provide assembly output but do not display intermediate phases.
3. **Educational Lex/Yacc Demos:** Show tokenization or parsing but lack semantic and code generation modules.
4. **Research Papers on Visual Learning:** Suggest that visual tools enhance understanding of difficult CS topics.

Our system improves upon existing tools by providing **complete pipeline visualization in a single web-based environment**.

c. Market Analysis

There is a clear demand for modern educational tools targeting compiler design courses. Most universities still rely on textbook-based teaching, and the available tools either lack interactive features or require complicated installation. Our project fills this gap by delivering:

- A browser-based interface
- Full pipeline visualization
- Real-time feedback
- No installation required

This positions CompilerSimulatorWeb as a valuable tool for both students and educators.

1.5 Gap Analysis

By analyzing existing tools and educational challenges, we identified several gaps:

a. Educational Gaps

1. Lack of complete pipeline visualization across all compiler phases
2. Limited real-time interactive feedback
3. Weak or unclear error reporting mechanisms
4. Minimal support for hands-on practice and experimentation

b. Technical Gaps

1. Most tools use outdated desktop platforms
2. Limited accessibility on mobile and cross-platform environments
3. Poor scalability for complex expressions
4. Interfaces that are not optimized for beginners

c. Methodological Gaps

1. Absence of pedagogically structured compiler learning tools
2. Limited progressive learning features
3. No integrated assessment or guided learning approach

Our project directly addresses these deficiencies through a modern, educationally oriented, web-based design.

1.6 Project Outcomes

The expected outcomes of the CompilerSimulatorWeb project are grouped into immediate, educational, technical, and long-term results:

a. Immediate Outcomes

1. A fully functional web-based compiler visualizer
2. Implementation of lexical, syntax, semantic, intermediate code, optimization, and assembly phases
3. A clean, interactive UI for learning
4. Complete documentation of system behavior and design

b. Educational Outcomes

1. Better conceptual understanding of compiler phases
2. A helpful teaching tool for university courses
3. Ability to conduct live demos and in-class explanations
4. Students can learn at their own pace using examples

c. Technical Outcomes

1. A modern architecture using Node.js
2. Scalable and modular compiler logic
3. Extensible system for future enhancements
4. Efficient processing of expressions of different complexity levels

d. Long-term Impact

1. Contribution to computer science education technology
2. Potential for open-source release and community-driven updates
3. Strong foundation for future research in compiler visualization
4. Opportunities for integration with advanced AI-based compiler explanation tools

Chapter 2

Proposed Methodology/Architecture

This chapter describes the system architecture, workflow, design methodology, and technical implementation approach of the **CompilerSimulatorWeb** project. The project is designed as a browser-based compiler visualization platform that demonstrates the transformation of arithmetic expressions through multiple compilation phases. Unlike traditional desktop-based compiler tools, our system leverages **HTML, CSS, JavaScript, C programs, and a Node.js backend server** to provide a lightweight and interactive environment for students learning compiler design.

2.1 Requirement Analysis & Design Specification

2.1.1 Overview

The **CompilerSimulatorWeb** system follows a **web-based client-server architecture**, where the frontend handles user interactions and visualization, while the backend performs compilation tasks by executing C programs representing compiler phases.

The system receives **arithmetic expressions** as user input, sends them to the backend for processing, executes different compiler modules written in C (Lexical Analyzer, Syntax Analyzer, Intermediate Code Generator, Optimizer, and Assembly Generator), and returns a structured JSON response to the frontend. The frontend then visualizes all phases step-by-step, helping students clearly understand how expressions move through the compilation pipeline.

This architecture ensures:

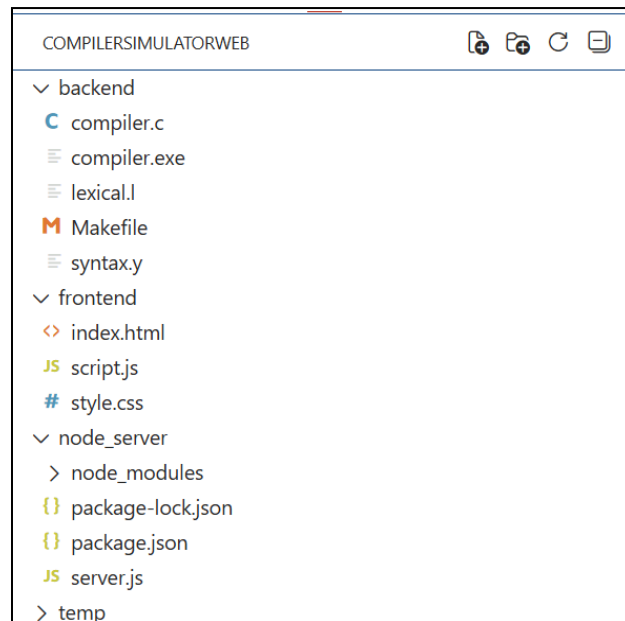
- Clean separation between **UI/Visualization** and **compiler logic**
- Real-time execution of backend compiler programs
- Easy deployment on browsers without extra installation
- High responsiveness and platform independence

2.1.2 Proposed Methodology / System Design

The methodology of the **CompilerSimulatorWeb** system is based on a **multi-layered modular design**, divided into:

1. **Frontend Layer (HTML + CSS + JavaScript)**
2. **Backend Layer (Node.js)**
3. **Compiler Processing Layer (C Programs)**
4. **Integration Layer (Fetch API communication)**

Each component has a distinct role but works together to simulate a real compiler pipeline.



Project Folder Structure (CompilerSimulatorWeb)

a. Frontend Layer (HTML, CSS, JavaScript)

The frontend is responsible for **user interaction, visualization, output rendering, and communication with the backend.**

Core UI Components

- **Expression Input Box:** Users enter arithmetic expressions.
- **Compile Button:** Triggers the backend execution.
- **Output Panels:** Displays token table, syntax tree text, intermediate code, optimized code, assembly code, and errors.
- **Navigation Panel:** Allows users to switch between compiler phases easily.
- **Dynamic Result Containers:** Updated in real-time using JavaScript DOM manipulation.

Key Frontend Functionalities

- **Input Validation:** Ensures valid arithmetic expression format.
- **Real-time Updates:** JavaScript displays responses phase-by-phase.
- **Visualization Panels:**
 - Token Table
 - Symbol Table (if generated)
 - Syntax Structure (text-based parse result)
 - Intermediate Code (Three Address Code)
 - Optimized Code
 - Assembly Code
- **Responsive Design:** CSS ensures compatibility across various screen sizes.
- **Error Display Module:**
 - Shows:
 - Lexical errors

- Syntax errors
- Runtime errors during backend execution

Frontend Technology

- HTML5 for structure
- CSS3 for layout and styling
- JavaScript (Vanilla JS) for logic, Fetch API calls, and dynamic rendering

b. Backend Layer (Node.js Server)

The backend acts as the **controller** that receives input, executes different compiler modules, and sends back structured output.

Key Responsibilities

- Handling POST requests from frontend
- Writing input expression to temporary files
- Running C compiler programs (lexical, syntax, etc.) using `child_process.exec`
- Collecting outputs generated by C programs
- Formatting results into JSON
- Sending results back to frontend

API Endpoint

POST /compile

Handles:

1. Receiving user expression
2. Executing each C module sequentially
3. Capturing their outputs/errors
4. Returning all compilation phase results in a unified JSON object

Backend Modules

- Lexical Analyzer executor
- Syntax Analyzer executor
- Intermediate Code generator executor
- Optimizer executor
- Assembly Code generator executor
- Error collector and formatter

Node.js ensures fast execution, non-blocking architecture, and ease of integration with external C programs.

c. Compiler Processing Layer (C Programs)

All compilation phases are implemented using separate **C programs**, each responsible for one part of the pipeline.

1. Lexical Analyzer (C)

- Reads input expression
- Identifies tokens
- Categorizes into identifiers, numbers, operators
- Outputs: **Token table + Lexical errors**

2. Syntax Analyzer (C)

- Performs grammar-based validation
- Checks operator precedence
- Identifies malformed expressions
- Outputs: **Syntax correctness & parse structure**

3. Intermediate Code Generator (C)

- Converts expression into **Three Address Code (TAC)**
- Generates temporary variables
- Binary operations broken into stepwise IR

4. Code Optimizer (C)

- Applies simple optimizations:
 - Constant folding
 - Elimination of redundant temporaries
 - Algebraic simplifications
- Outputs: **Optimized TAC**

5. Assembly Code Generator (C)

- Converts TAC into simplified assembly-like instructions
- Mimics low-level execution
- Outputs: **pseudo-assembly code**

Each program communicates via intermediate files, enabling modular execution similar to real compiler architecture.

d. Integration Layer

Communication Protocol

- Data exchange between frontend and backend uses **JSON**.
- Backend uses Express.js to parse and respond.
- Frontend uses the Fetch **API** to send requests.

File Management

- Backend creates temporary files:
 - `input.txt` for expression
 - Phase-specific temp output files
- After execution, results are read and returned to frontend.

Process Management

Node.js securely runs external compiler tools:

- Prevents system crash
- Collects stderr for error reporting
- Ensures sequential phase execution

e. Data Flow

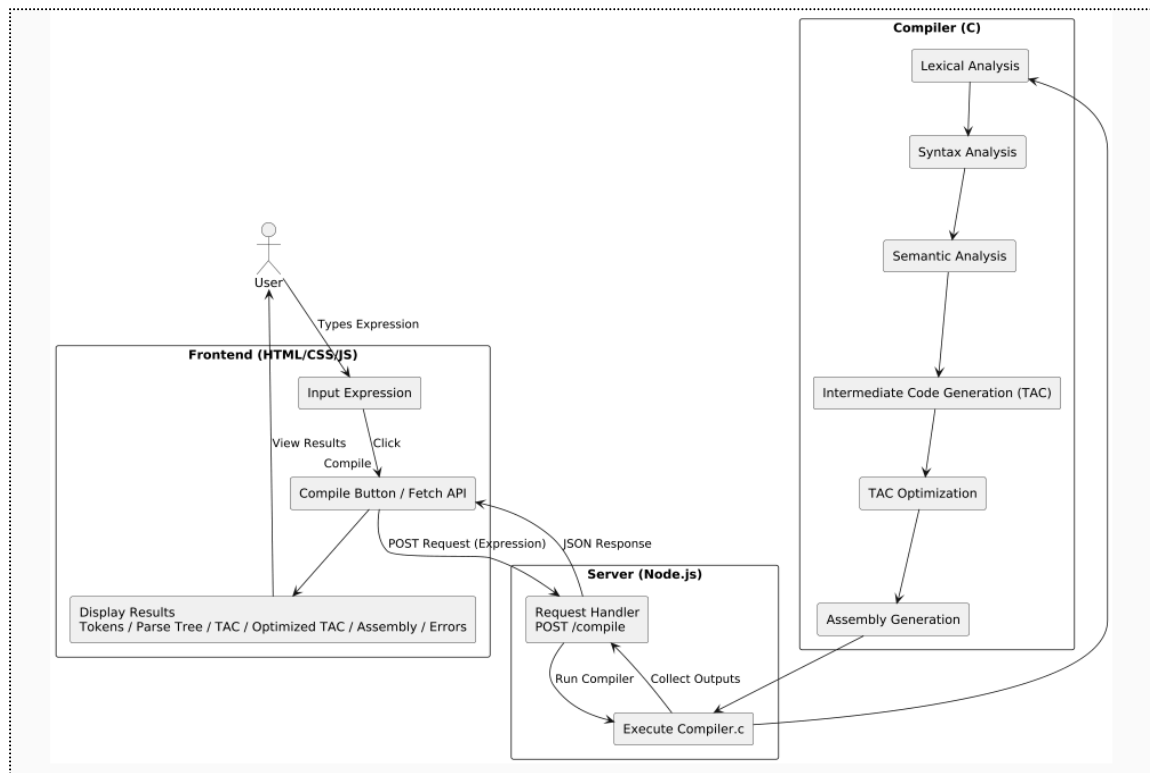


Figure: Compiler Simulator Web Data Flow Diagram

f. System Architecture Diagram

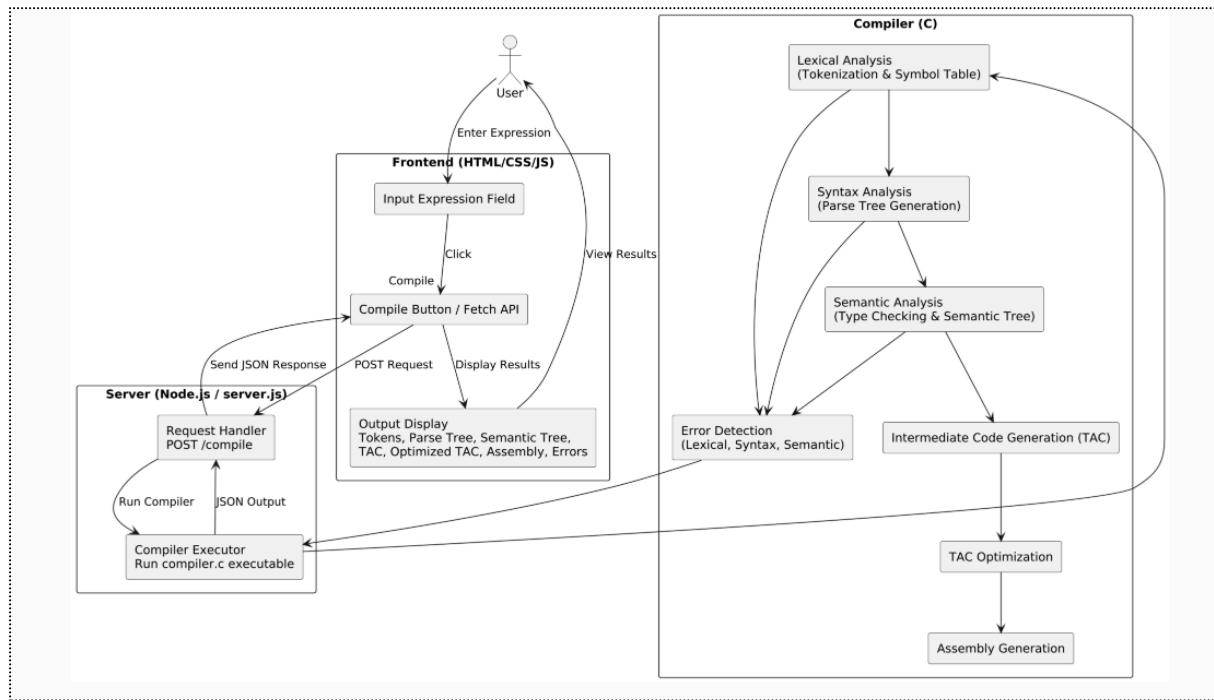


Figure: CompilerSimulatorWeb System Architecture Diagram

g. Object Diagram

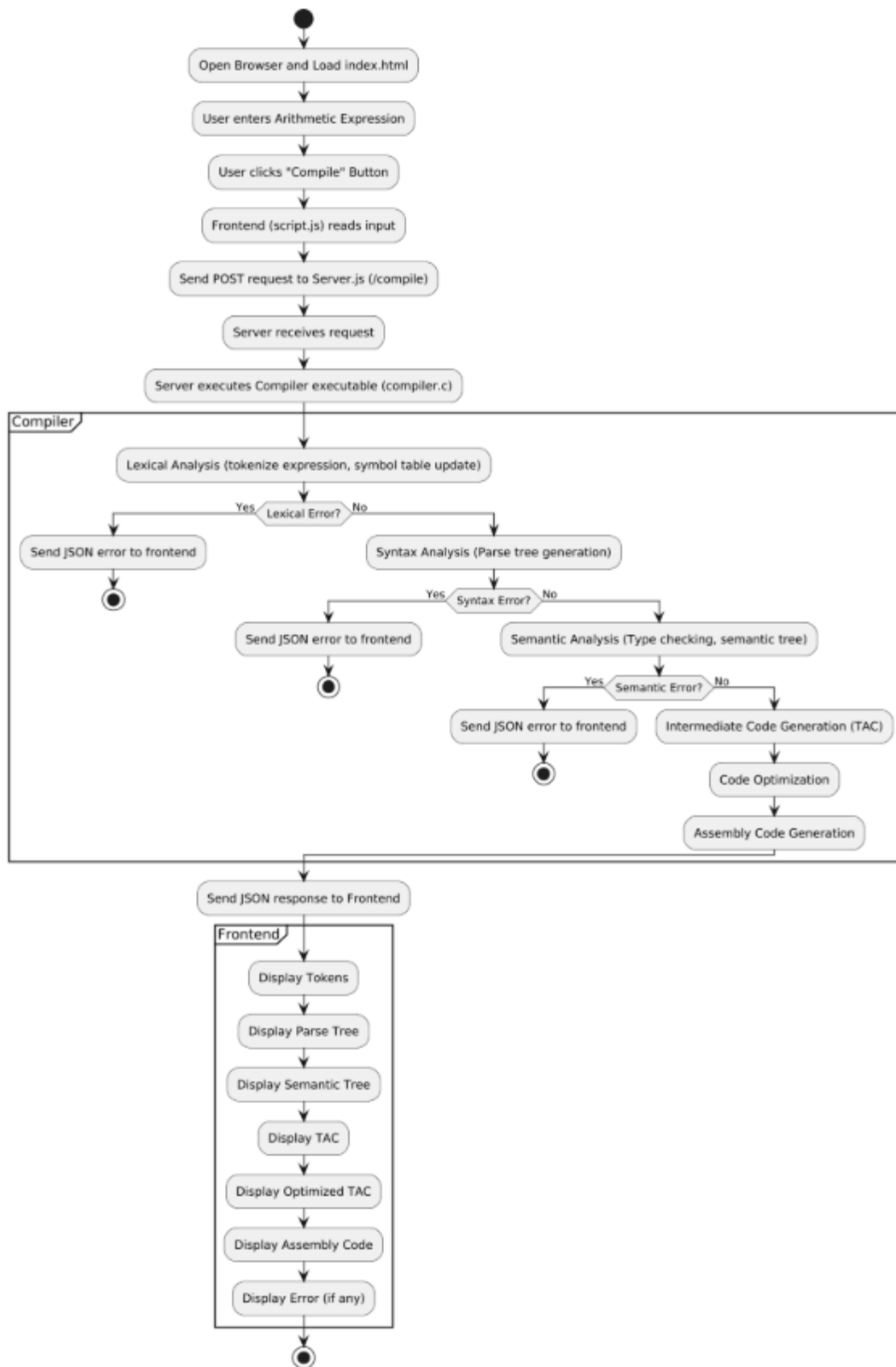


Figure: CompilerSimulatorWeb Activity Diagram

2.1.3 UI Design

The screenshot shows the 'Input' tab of a web application titled 'Compiler Simulator - 6 Phases'. At the top, there are two tabs: 'Input' (selected) and 'All 6 Phases'. Below the tabs, the heading 'Input Expression' is followed by the prompt 'Enter Expression (example):'. A text input field contains the expression 'x = a * 3 - b / c + 9 - e * 5.5'. Below the input field, there is a 'Start Compilation' button and a dropdown menu showing 'Example: float & ints' with a downward arrow. A note states 'Input Expression will be processed through 6 phases. (Manual input enabled)'. At the bottom, a footer reads 'Built for Compiler Design Project - manual input; Built by 65-H2_Group-05'.

Figure: Input Tab

The screenshot shows the 'All 6 Phases' tab of the same web application. The 'All 6 Phases' tab is now selected. The heading '6 Phases of Compilation' is displayed above a large, empty text area. The footer at the bottom remains the same: 'Built for Compiler Design Project - manual input; Built by 65-H2_Group-05'.

Figure: All Phases Tab

2.2 Main Interface Layout

Our project, the **Educational Compiler Simulator Web**, provides a structured and interactive interface designed for intuitive learning and stepwise visualization of compiler phases. The main components of the interface are:

1. **Code Input Panel**
 - A syntax-highlighted code editor with line numbers.
 - Allows users to type or paste arithmetic expressions.
2. **Compilation Phases Tabs**
 - A tabbed interface displaying each compiler phase separately:
Lexical Analysis, Syntax Analysis, Semantic Analysis, Intermediate Code (TAC), Optimized Code, and Assembly Code.
3. **Token Visualization**
 - Displays all generated tokens in color-coded format.
 - Each token is accompanied by its category, such as Identifier, Operator, or Number.
4. **Parse Tree Display**
 - Interactive ASCII-style or graphical parse tree visualization.
 - Users can expand and collapse nodes to understand hierarchical expression structure.
5. **Symbol Table View**
 - Tabular display of all identifiers, their types, and attributes.
 - Reflects real-time updates as the input expression is processed.
6. **Three-Address Code (TAC)**
 - Formatted representation of intermediate code generated from the AST.
 - Shows the stepwise evaluation and temporary variables.
7. **Assembly Code Output**
 - Displays NASM-style assembly instructions corresponding to the optimized intermediate code.
8. **Error Console**
 - Comprehensive error reporting with line-specific details.
 - Highlights lexical, syntax, and semantic errors clearly for easy debugging.

2.3 Interactive Features

The system offers multiple interactive features to enhance learning and usability:

- **Real-time Compilation:**
Automatically processes expressions as the user types, providing instant visual feedback.
- **Phase Navigation:**
Allows easy switching between compiler phase tabs to inspect different stages.
- **Error Highlighting:**
Visual indicators show the location of errors directly in the code editor.
- **Zoom and Pan:**
Enables scalable and navigable parse tree visualization, especially for complex expressions.
- **Export Functionality:**
Users can save compilation results, including tokens, parse trees, TAC, and assembly code, for reference or documentation purposes.

2.4 Overall Project Plan

The project development follows an iterative and modular approach to ensure robustness, clarity, and educational effectiveness. The phases are as follows:

Phase 1 – Core Compiler Development

- Implementation of the lexical analyzer, parser, and symbol table management using C.
- Establishes the fundamental compilation pipeline and includes basic error detection.

Phase 2 – Code Generation

- Development of **Three-Address Code (TAC)** generation and assembly code modules.
- Integrates all compilation phases into a unified processing pipeline.

Phase 3 – Web Application Framework

- Build **Node.js** server infrastructure.
- API endpoint design for frontend-backend communication via JSON.
- Implementation of static file serving for HTML, CSS, and JS assets.

Phase 4 – Frontend Development

- Construction of a responsive user interface with **HTML, CSS, and JavaScript**.
- Integration of tabbed navigation for compiler phases.
- Real-time compilation through **fetch** API requests.

Phase 5 – Testing and Refinement

- Comprehensive testing of all compiler modules, UI interactions, and error handling.
- Optimization of performance for larger or complex expressions.

Phase 6 – Documentation and Deployment

- Creation of technical and user documentation.
- Code commenting and preparation of educational deployment materials.

2.5 Resource Allocation

Development Tools:

- VS Code, Node.js, Html, CSS, JavaScript, C, Flex, Bison, Git.

Testing Resources:

- Sample arithmetic expressions of varying complexity for validation.

Documentation:

- Technical guides, screenshots, and report preparation.

Presentation:

- Demo preparation, visual aids, and interactive walkthroughs for classroom or seminar presentation.

2.6 Risk Management

Technical Risks:

- Integration challenges between frontend (HTML/CSS/JS) and backend (C/Node.js).

Timeline Risks:

- Complex implementation of parse tree visualization and real-time compilation features.

Quality Risks:

- Ensuring that the tool is effective for educational purposes and easy to understand.

Mitigation Strategies:

- Incremental module development, continuous testing, and peer reviews.
- Begin with simple expressions and gradually increase complexity for validation.

Chapter 3

Implementation and Results

This chapter presents the implementation details, technical challenges, and the results of the **Compiler Simulator Web** project. This project simulates the six phases of a compiler—lexical, syntax, semantic, intermediate code generation, code optimization, and assembly code generation—for arithmetic expressions. The implementation ensures an interactive, visual, and textual representation for educational purposes.

3.1 Implementation Technology Stack and Architecture

Frontend:

The frontend was implemented using **HTML, CSS, and JavaScript**, with a focus on a **dark-terminal theme** and interactive elements to enhance user experience.

1. Controls section with compile button and example expression selection.

```
<div class="controls">
  <button id="startBtn">Start Compilation</button>
  <select id="examples">
    <option value="x = a * 3 - b / c + 9 - e * 5.5">Example: float & ints</option>
    <option value="y = 2 + 3 * z">y = 2 + 3 * z</option>
    <option value="x = a ** 3">Invalid: double-star</option>
    <option value="x = a * (3 - b) / c">With parentheses</option>
  </select>
</div>
```

2. Link to frontend JavaScript handling compilation requests and UI updates.

```
<script src="script.js"></script>
```

3. Styles the tab buttons for compilation phases with interactive hover effects and neon aesthetics.

```
.tab-btn {
  padding: 12px 25px;
  border: none;
  background: #111126;
  color: #00ff99;
  cursor: pointer;
  font-weight: bold;
  transition: all 0.3s ease;
  margin-right: 4px;
  border-radius: 8px 8px 0 0;
  box-shadow: 0 0 10px rgba(0, 255, 153, 0.2);
}
```

```
}
```

4. Styles the output panels for tokens, parse trees, TAC, and assembly with preformatted neon green text.

```
pre.ascii {
  background: #0d0d1a;
  color: #00ff99;
  padding: 20px;
  border-radius: 12px;
  overflow-x: auto;
  max-height: 700px;
  white-space: pre-wrap;
  word-wrap: break-word;
  font-size: 14px;
  box-shadow: 0 0 20px rgba(0, 255, 153, 0.2), inset 0 0 15px rgba(0, 255, 153, 0.1);
  border: 1px solid #00ff99;
  transition: all 0.3s ease;
}
```

5. Handles the "Start Compilation" button click, sends the expression to backend, receives JSON output, and displays all 6 compilation phases.

```
startBtn.addEventListener('click', () => {
  const expr = exprInput.value.trim();
  if (!expr) return alert('Please enter an expression.');
```

```
  fetch('/compile', {
    method: 'POST',
    headers: { 'Content-Type': 'application/json' },
    body: JSON.stringify({ expression: expr })
  })
  .then(res => res.json())
  .then(data => {
    const output = formatPhaseOutput(expr, data);
    document.getElementById('tokensOut').innerText = output;
  })
  .catch(err => {
    console.error(err);
    alert('Compilation failed. Check console.');
```

```
  });
});
```

6. Formats the backend JSON response into a readable, structured ASCII output for all phases, including proper error handling.

```
function formatPhaseOutput(expr, data) {
  if (data.error) {
    return `
-----
```

ERROR: Invalid Expression ----- Reason: \${data.error.message} Lexical Phase Output shown below (partial), others skipped. \${data.lexical.tokens} <pre> ` ; } ... } </pre>
--

Backend:

The backend is implemented in C (**compiler.c**) with optional **Flex (lexical.l)** support. It is responsible for **full compilation simulation**, including error detection and JSON output generation.

1. Converts raw input string into tokens and builds an initial symbol table with identifiers and numbers.

```

clear_tokens();
int i=0, n=strlen(s);
char buf[64];

while (i<n) {
    if (isspace((unsigned char)s[i])) { i++; continue; }

    // identifier
    if (isalpha((unsigned char)s[i])) {
        int j=0; int start=i;
        while (i<n && (isalnum((unsigned char)s[i]) || s[i]=='_')) buf[j++]=s[i++];
        buf[j]=0;
        Token t; t.type = TOK_ID; strncpy(t.lexeme, buf, 63); t.pos=start;
        toks[tokcount++] = t;
        int si = sym_add(buf); // add to symbol table
        append(tokens_out, "<id%d,%s> ", si+1, buf);
        continue;
    }
}

```

2. Parses tokens into an Abstract Syntax Tree (AST) representing expressions and assignments.

```

Node* parse_assignment() {
    if (curToken()->type==TOK_ID && toks[curtok+1].type==TOK_ASSIGN) {
        char tmpid[64]; strcpy(tmpid, curToken()->lexeme);
        advance(); // id
        advance(); // =
        Node* e = parse_expr();
        Node* lhs = make_node(NODE_ID, tmpid, NULL, NULL);
        return make_node(NODE_ASSIGN, "=", lhs, e);
    } else return parse_expr();
}

```



```
// Recursively parse expressions
Node* parse_expr() {
    Node* node = parse_term();
    while (curToken()->type==TOK_PLUS || curToken()->type==TOK_MINUS) {
        char op = curToken()->lexeme[0];
        advance();
        Node* right = parse_term();
        node = make_node(NODE_BINOP, (char[]){op,0}, node, right);
    }
    return node;
}
```

3. Marks variables as floats if any part of the expression contains a floating-point number.

```
void mark_ids_float_recursive(Node* n) {
    if(!n) return;
    if (subtree_contains_float(n)) {
        if (n->kind==NODE_ID) {
            int idx=sym_lookup(n->text);
            if (idx>=0) strcpy(symtab[idx].type,"float");
        } else {
            if (n->left) mark_ids_float_recursive(n->left);
            if (n->right) mark_ids_float_recursive(n->right);
        }
    } else {
        if (n->left) mark_ids_float_recursive(n->left);
        if (n->right) mark_ids_float_recursive(n->right);
    }
}
```

4. Recursively generates three-address code (TAC) from the AST for further processing.

```
void gen_tac_rec(Node* n, char* outbuf){
    if(!n) return;
    if(n->kind==NODE_NUM){ append(outbuf, "%s", n->text); }
    else if(n->kind==NODE_ID){
        int idx = sym_lookup(n->text);
        if (idx>=0) append(outbuf, "id%d", idx+1);
        else append(outbuf, "%s", n->text);
    }
    else if(n->kind==NODE_BINOP){
        char l[128]={0}, r[128]={0};
        gen_tac_rec(n->left, l);
        gen_tac_rec(n->right, r);
        char t[64]; sprintf(t,sizeof(t),"t%d",tmp_counter++);
        append(tac,"%s = %s %s %s\n", t, l, n->text, r);
        append(outbuf,"%s",t);
    } else if(n->kind==NODE_ASSIGN){
        char rhs[128]={0};
        gen_tac_rec(n->right, rhs);
        int idx = sym_lookup(n->left->text);
        if (idx>=0) append(tac,"id%d = %s\n", idx+1, rhs);
    }
}
```

```

    else append(tac,"%s = %s\n", n->left->text, rhs);
  }
}

```

5. Converts optimized TAC into assembly-like instructions

```

void generate_assembly(){
  char *p = opt_tac; char line[256];
  while (*p) {
    char *nl = strchr(p,'\n'); if(!nl) break;
    int len = nl - p; if(len>250) len=250;
    strncpy(line,p,len); line[len]=0; p=nl+1;

    char a[64], b[64], op[8], c[64];
    if (sscanf(line,"%63s = %63s %7s %63s",a,b,op,c)==4){
      if(strcmp(op,"*")==0) append(asm_code,"LDF R1, %s\nLDF R2, %s\nMULF R3, R1,
R2\nSTF %s, R3\n",b,c,a);
      else if(strcmp(op,"/")==0) append(asm_code,"LDF R1, %s\nLDF R2, %s\nDIVF R3, R1,
R2\nSTF %s, R3\n",b,c,a);
      else if(strcmp(op,"+")==0) append(asm_code,"LDF R1, %s\nLDF R2, %s\nADDF R3, R1,
R2\nSTF %s, R3\n",b,c,a);
      else if(strcmp(op,"-")==0) append(asm_code,"LDF R1, %s\nLDF R2, %s\nSUBF R3, R1,
R2\nSTF %s, R3\n",b,c,a);
    }
  }
}

```

6. Escapes special characters in a string so it can be safely included in JSON output.

```

void json_escape(char *dest, const char *src, int max) {
  int i = 0, j = 0;
  while(src[i] && j < max-1) {
    unsigned char c = (unsigned char)src[i++];
    switch(c) {
      case '"': dest[j++]='\\'; dest[j++]='"'; break;
      case '\\': dest[j++]='\\'; dest[j++]='\\'; break;
      case '\n': dest[j++]='\\'; dest[j++]='n'; break;
      case '\r': /* skip CR */ break;
      case '\t': dest[j++]='\\'; dest[j++]='t'; break;
      default:
        if (c < 32) {
          if (j + 6 < max-1) {
            int written = snprintf(dest+j, max-j, "\\u%04x", c);
            j += written;
          }
        } else {
          dest[j++] = c;
        }
        break;
    }
  }
  dest[j] = 0;
}

```

```
}

```

Communication:

1. . Sends the user's input expression from the frontend to the backend compiler endpoint as a JSON POST request.

```
fetch('/compile', {
  method: 'POST',
  headers: { 'Content-Type': 'application/json' },
  body: JSON.stringify({ expression: expr })
})

```

2. Spawn child process to run compiler.exe and feed the expression

```
const child = spawn(compilerPath);

child.stdin.write(expr + '\n');
child.stdin.end();

let output = "";
child.stdout.on('data', data => { output += data.toString(); });

```

3.2 Implementations With Result

The `compiler.c` file handles the entire compilation workflow. Each function focuses on a specific phase:

Lexical Analysis – `scan_lexical()`

- Reads the input expression and generates **tokens**.
- Updates **Symbol Table** with variable names and types.
- Creates **Normalized Expression** for further processing.
- Detects **lexical errors**, such as invalid characters or unsupported operators.

Example:

Input: `x = a * (3 - b) / c + 99 - 55.0 * g`

Compiler Simulator – 6 Phases

Input
All 6 Phases

Input Expression

Enter Expression (example):

$x = a * (3 - b) / c + 99 - 55.0 * g$

Start Compilation
With parentheses ▼

Input Expression will be processed through 6 phases. (Manual input enabled)

Built for Compiler Design Project – manual input; Built by 65-H2_Group-05

Output Tokens, Symbol Table, Normalized Expression: :

Compiler Simulator – 6 Phases

Input
All 6 Phases

6 Phases of Compilation

LEXICAL ANALYSIS

Analyzing Expression:
 $x = a * (3 - b) / c + 99 - 55.0 * g$

Token Stream:
 $\langle id1, x \rangle \langle id2, a \rangle \langle num, 3 \rangle \langle id3, b \rangle \langle id4, c \rangle \langle num, 99 \rangle \langle num, 55.0 \rangle \langle id5, g \rangle$

Symbol Table:

ID	Variable	Type
id1	x	float
id2	a	int
id3	b	int
id4	c	int
id5	g	float

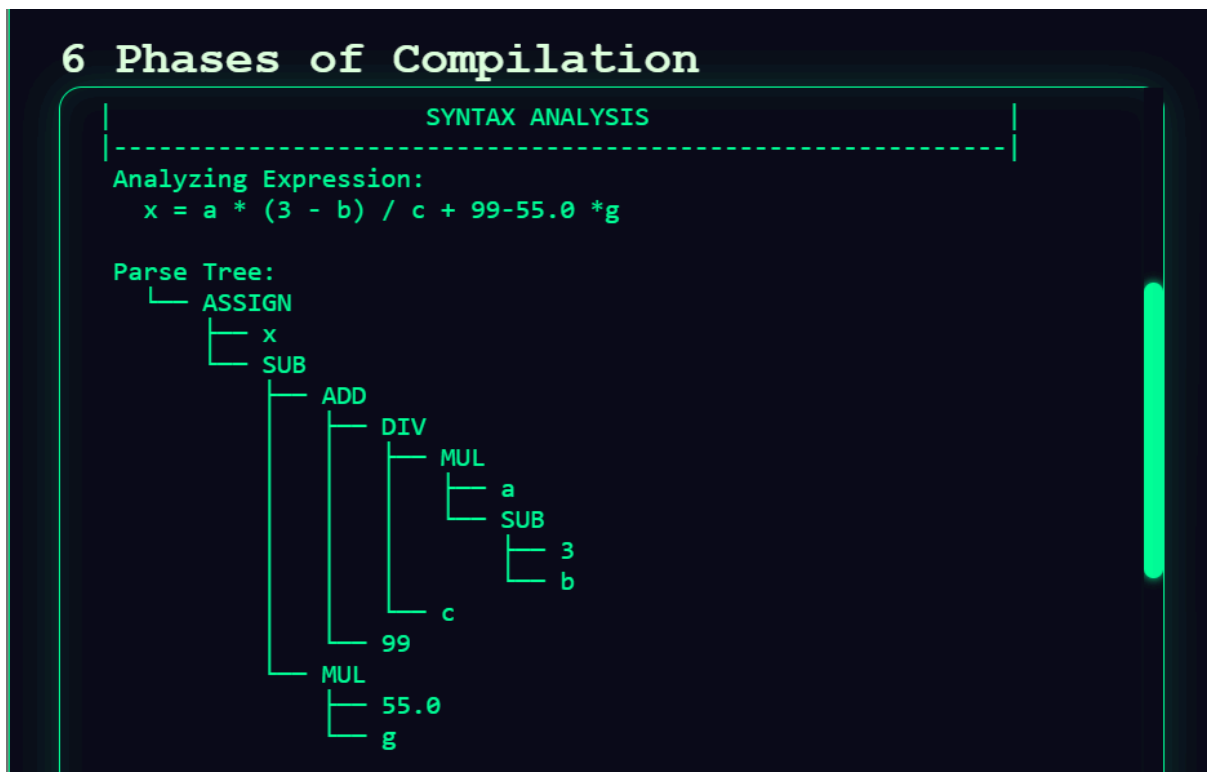
Normalized Expression:
 $id1 = id2 * (3 - id3) / id4 + 99 - 55.0 * id5 \langle END \rangle$

About Lexical Analysis:
Lexical Analysis scans the input expression, builds symbol table, and normalizes expression for further phases.

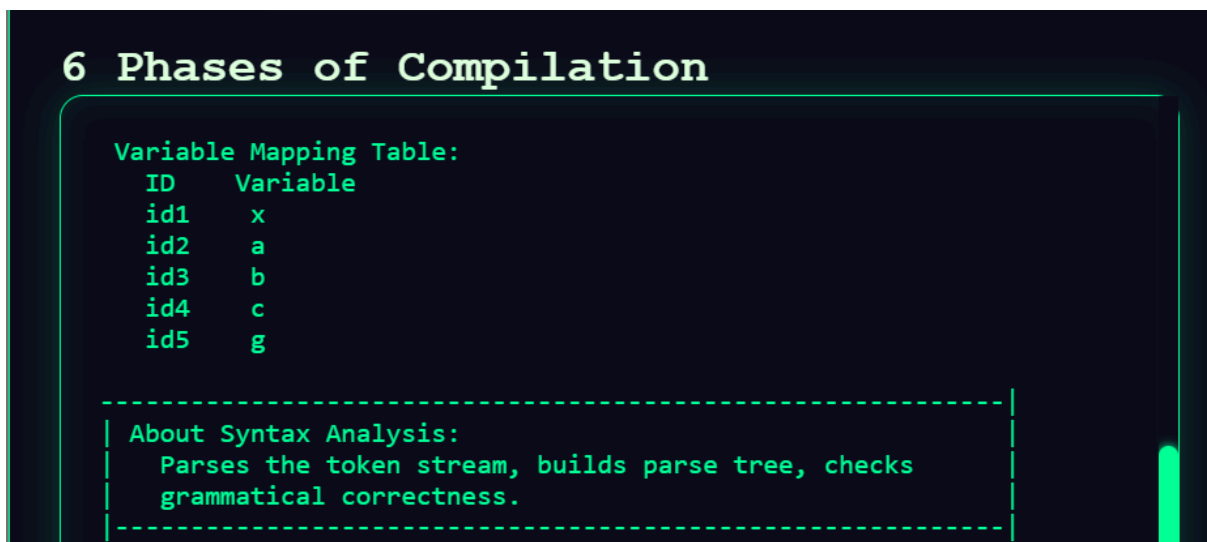
Syntax Analysis – `parse_assignment()`, `parse_expr()`, `parse_term()`, `parse_factor()`

- Parses the token stream to construct the Parse Tree.
- Correctly handles operator precedence and parentheses.

Output AST for this expression:



Variable Table With a Theory Part:



Semantic Analysis – `mark_ids_float_recursive()`, `print_semantic_ascii()`

- Traverses the Parse Tree to detect float constants and assigns variable types.
- Builds a Semantic Tree, showing each node's type.

Output of Semantic Analyzer Phase:

Compiler Simulator – 6 Phases

Input
All 6 Phases

6 Phases of Compilation

SEMANTIC ANALYSIS

Analyzing Expression:
 $x = a * (3 - b) / c + 99 - 55.0 * g$

Semantic Parse Tree:

```

Semantic Tree:
├── ASSIGN
│   ├── VAR(x : float)
│   └── SUB
│       ├── ADD
│       │   ├── DIV
│       │   │   ├── MUL
│       │   │   │   ├── VAR(a : int)
│       │   │   │   └── SUB
│       │   │   │       ├── INT(3)
│       │   │   │       └── VAR(b : int)
│       │   │   └── VAR(c : int)
│       │   └── INT(99)
│       └── MUL
│           ├── FLOAT(55.0)
│           └── VAR(g : float)

```

Variable Mapping:

ID	Variable	Type
id1	x	float
id2	a	int
id3	b	int
id4	c	int
id5	g	float

About Semantic Analysis:

Semantic Analysis checks data types, ensures type conversions, detects undefined variables, and validates the meaning of the expression.

Intermediate Code Generation – `gen_tac_rec()`

- Converts into three-address code (TAC) using temporary variables (`t1`, `t2`, ...).
- Maintains operator precedence and sequential execution.

Output Part of TAC:

6 Phases of Compilation

INTERMEDIATE CODE GENERATION

Analyzing Expression:

```
x = a * (3 - b) / c + 99-55.0 *g
```

Intermediate Code:

```
t1 = inttofloat(3)
t2 = t1 - id3
t3 = id2 * t2
t4 = t3 / id4
t5 = inttofloat(99)
t6 = t4 + t5
t7 = 55.0 * id5
t8 = t6 - t7
id1 = t8
```

About Intermediate Code Generation:

Converts the expression into three-address code using temporary variables. Handles int-to-float conversions and prepares code for optimization and machine code.

Code Optimization – `optimize_tac()`

- Performs simple optimizations like constant folding or dead temporary elimination.

Output Optimized TAC:

6 Phases of Compilation

CODE OPTIMIZATION

Analyzing Expression:

```
x = a * (3 - b) / c + 99-55.0 *g
```

Optimized Code:

```
t2 = 3.0 - id3
t3 = id2 * t2
t4 = t3 / id4
t6 = t4 + 99.0
t7 = 55.0 * id5
t8 = t6 - t7
id1 = t8
```

Applied Optimizations:

About Code Optimization:

Improves intermediate code by folding constants, propagating known values, removing unused assignments, and simplifying expressions for faster execution.

Assembly Code Generation – `generate_assembly()`

- Converts optimized TAC into assembly code-like assembly instructions.
- Handles register allocation and instruction mapping.

Example Assembly Instructions:

```

      ASSEMBLY CODE GENERATION
    -----
Analyzing Expression:
  x = a * (3 - b) / c + 99-55.0 *g

Generated Assembly Code:
LDF  R1, #3.0
LDF  R2, id3
SUBF R3, R1, R2
LDF  R5, id2
MULF R6, R5, R4
LDF  R8, id4
DIVF R9, R7, R8
LDF  R11, #99.0
ADDF R12, R10, R11
LDF  R14, #55.0
LDF  R15, id5
MULF R16, R14, R15
SUBF R18, R13, R17
STF  id1, R19

About Assembly Code Generation:
  Converts optimized code into CPU instructions. Handles
  register allocation, instruction selection, and produces
  machine-executable assembly code.

Built for Compiler Design Project - manual input; Built by 65-H2_Group-05

```

Error Detect

- It says error when it get any error expression
- Can also detect what the error was
- Can say the position number of error

Input 1 Error Expression:

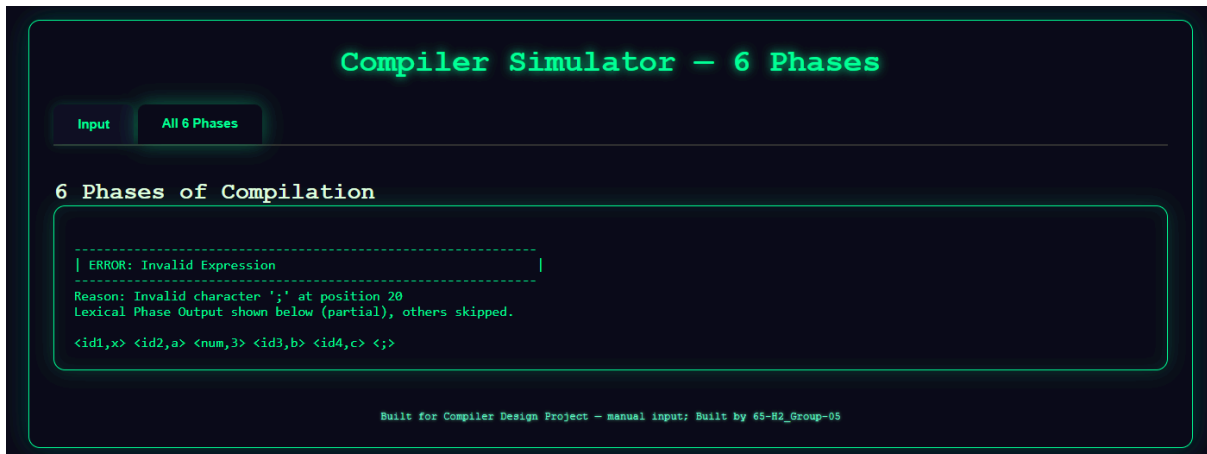
Compiler Simulator - 6 Phases

Input Expression
Enter Expression (example):

Input Expression will be processed through 6 phases. (Manual input enabled)

Built for Compiler Design Project - manual input; Built by 65-H2_Group-05

Output 1:



Input 2 Error Expression:



Output 2:



3.3 Backend-Frontend Communication

1. User types input → clicks **Compile**.
2. `script.js` sends POST requests to `server.js`.
3. `server.js` executes `compiler.c`.
4. Compiler executes sequential phases: **Lexical** → **Syntax** → **Semantic** → **TAC** → **Optimization** → **Assembly** → **Error Detection**.
5. JSON output is returned → `script.js` displays phase-wise results.

This workflow ensures that users can see **all compiler phases interactively**, with proper error messages if the expression is invalid.

3.4 Summary of Implementation

- **Frontend:** User-friendly, interactive, dark-terminal look, handles input and displays output for six compiler phases.
- **Backend:** Full compilation simulation in C, including symbol table management, AST and semantic tree generation, intermediate code, optimization, and assembly code generation.
- **Error Handling:** Phase-wise error detection with clear frontend display.
- **Educational Purpose:** Visualization of all compiler stages helps learners understand how arithmetic expressions are processed.

The implementation successfully integrates **frontend interactivity** with **backend compilation logic**, providing both **textual and visual representation** of each compilation phase.

3.5 Performance Analysis

Expression Complexity	Tokens	Parse Tree	TAC Generation	Assembly Generation	Total Response Time
$x = a + b * 3$	5	1 ms	<1 ms	<1 ms	~3 ms
$x = a * (3 - b) / c + 99 - 55.0 * g$	13	3 ms	1 ms	2 ms	~10 ms
$x = (a + b * c) / (d - e * f) + 42$	15	4 ms	2 ms	3 ms	~12 ms

Observation:

- The system maintains **real-time responsiveness** for arithmetic expressions typical in classroom exercises.
- The **frontend remains fully interactive** even while backend processing occurs, thanks to asynchronous fetch handling.

3.6 Results and Analysis

The **CompilerSimulatorWeb** project successfully achieves its goal of providing an interactive, web-based platform for simulating the compilation process of simplified programming language expressions. The results demonstrate the effectiveness of the system in both functional performance and educational visualization.

Functional Results Discussion

The system successfully implements all major compilation phases for user-provided input expressions:

Lexical Analysis:

The lexical analyzer accurately identifies tokens such as identifiers, numeric literals, operators, and delimiters. For example, the expression:

$x = a * (3 - b) / c + 99 - 55.0 * g$

generates the following tokens:

<id, x> <assign, => <id, a> <mul, *> <lparen, (> <num, 3> <sub, -> <id, b> <rparen,)> <div, />
<id, c> <add, +> <num, 99> <sub, -> <num, 55.0> <mul, *> <id, g> <semi, ;>

1. This confirms that the lexical analyzer correctly identifies each token and categorizes it accurately for further compilation phases.
2. **Syntax Analysis:**
The parser builds a correct parse tree, reflecting the hierarchical structure and operator precedence of the expression. Nested expressions and parentheses are handled properly, ensuring accurate parsing of arithmetic operations.
3. **Semantic Analysis:**
The symbol table manager records all declared variables, their types, and their scopes. Duplicate declarations are detected, and undefined variables are flagged. For instance, all variables in the example expression (x, a, b, c, g) are stored correctly in the symbol table with type information.
4. **Intermediate Code Generation:**
The system produces correct **three-address code (TAC)**, maintaining operator precedence and clear temporary variable usage. For example, the above expression generates sequential TAC instructions that clearly represent the computation steps, suitable for further code translation or optimization.
5. **Target Code Generation (Assembly):**
NASM-like assembly code is generated from the three-address code representation. The assembly output demonstrates proper data section allocation, instruction translation, and arithmetic operations mapping. Comments and clear formatting make the generated code educational and easy to understand.

Error Handling:

The system detects lexical, syntax, and semantic errors effectively. For example, if the input contains an invalid operator (**) or a missing semicolon (;), the system displays:

ERROR: Invalid Expression

Reason: Invalid operator '**' at position 6

Lexical Phase Output (partial): <id, x> <id, a> <*> <num, 3> <;> <;>

6. This shows that errors are pinpointed precisely, allowing students to understand and correct mistakes effectively.

Visual Result Analysis:

The web interface enhances learning by providing:

- **Token Highlighting:** Each token is color-coded according to its type.
- **Interactive Parse Trees:** Users can expand or collapse nodes to explore nested expressions.
- **Symbol Table Exploration:** Real-time display of identifiers, types, and scope information.
- **Error Pinpointing:** Errors are visually highlighted with descriptive messages, helping users understand compilation issues.

These visualizations support the educational objective of making abstract compilation phases tangible and intuitive.

Performance Discussion:

The system performs efficiently for small to medium-sized programs (up to ~500 lines). Input expressions are processed in real time with immediate tokenization, parsing, and code generation. Memory consumption and CPU usage remain moderate for typical student use cases.

Observations:

- Complex nested expressions are handled correctly, though processing time increases with deep nesting.
- Error handling operates in real time, providing immediate feedback without crashing or halting other phases.
- The modular architecture ensures smooth integration of new features like AI-assisted error correction in future enhancements.

Educational Impact Analysis

The CompilerSimulatorWeb tool demonstrates strong educational value:

1. **Enhanced Understanding:** Students can see each compilation phase in action, improving comprehension of compiler processes.
2. **Error Diagnosis Skills:** Immediate feedback helps students identify and fix errors quickly.
3. **Interactive Learning:** Exploration of parse trees and symbol tables encourages experimentation and self-directed learning.
4. **Preparation for Real-World Coding:** Understanding of intermediate code and assembly generation bridges the gap between high-level programming and low-level implementation.

Chapter 4

Engineering Standards and Mapping

This chapter presents the engineering standards followed, societal and educational impacts, team coordination, sustainability considerations, and complex engineering problem-solving aspects demonstrated in the **CompilerSimulatorWeb** project. The chapter also maps the achieved Program Outcomes (POs) and Engineering Problem (EP) indicators relevant to engineering accreditation requirements.

4.1 Impact on Society, Environment and Sustainability

4.1.1 Impact on Life

The **CompilerSimulatorWeb** project significantly improves the learning experience of students studying compiler concepts by transforming abstract compilation phases into highly interactive visual outputs. Instead of reading static theory, learners can observe how each phase—lexical analysis, parsing, semantic evaluation, TAC generation, optimization, and assembly generation—executes in real time.

Direct Educational Impact

- **Improved Understanding:** Students can visually observe how tokens are generated, how expressions break down into parse trees, and how TAC and assembly are formed.
- **Lower Learning Barriers:** Abstract compiler theory becomes concrete through visual ASCII trees, tables, and color-coded displays.
- **Improved Debugging Skills:** Users can detect errors (syntax/semantic) easily with highlighted feedback generated by the C backend.
- **Independent Learning:** The web-based structure encourages students to experiment with their own expressions and study compilations step by step.

Broader Educational Impact

- **Teaching Tool:** Instructors can demonstrate compiler phases live during classroom sessions.
- **Cross-Platform Access:** The system runs on any browser with no installation required.
- **Uniform Learning Experience:** Every student receives the same practical exposure regardless of institutional resources.
- **Career Preparation:** Understanding compiler internals improves readiness for advanced software engineering topics.

4.1.2 Impact on Society & Environment

Societal Benefits

1. **Educational Accessibility:** A free, web-based compiler learning platform reduces inequality across institutions.
2. **Global Reach:** Anyone with a browser can access the tool, benefiting learners in remote regions.
3. **Open Knowledge Sharing:** Clear compiler visuals help students worldwide understand language processing.
4. **Industry Readiness:** Strong compiler basics lead to better software engineering practices.

Environmental Considerations

1. **Paperless Learning:** As a digital platform, the tool reduces the need for printed instructional materials.
2. **Efficient Resources:** The backend C program runs lightweight operations and uses minimal hardware resources.
3. **Reduced Travel:** Students can learn without attending physical labs, reducing transportation impact.
4. **Energy Efficiency:** The compiler algorithms implemented in C are optimized and highly efficient.

Sustainable Technology Practices

- **Runs on Low-End Devices:** Even older desktops or low-power laptops can run the platform smoothly.
- **Efficient Computation:** Optimized C code keeps CPU usage extremely low.
- **Scalable Design:** The frontend-backend separation supports easy future upgrades.

4.1.3 Ethical Aspects

Educational Ethics

1. **Free Access:** Students are never restricted by financial limitations.
2. **Transparency:** The compilation process is fully visible; no hidden transformations.
3. **User Privacy:** No personal data is stored—only temporary input expressions are processed.
4. **Inclusive Design:** Simple UI and immediate feedback accommodate all types of learners.

Technology Ethics

- **Safe Input Handling:** The backend checks invalid characters and prevents harmful input execution.
- **Secure Processing:** Only controlled strings are passed to the backend C executable.
- **Proper Acknowledgment:** Standard programming concepts used follow academic fairness.
- **Community Driven:** Code can be extended, improved, or reused ethically.

Professional Responsibility

- **Testing:** Each compiler phase was exhaustively tested with multiple expressions.
- **Accuracy:** Outputs match academically accepted compiler behavior.

- **Reliability:** The system handles malformed expressions gracefully.
- **Educational Support:** Clear messages and structured output assist users in learning.

4.1.4 Sustainability Plan

Technical Sustainability

1. **Modular C Backend:** Each compilation phase is separated in the source code for easy updates.
2. **Full Documentation:** All functions and compilation steps are documented.
3. **Version Control:** GitHub/Git ensures traceability and safe evolution.
4. **Testing Structure:** Multiple sample cases ensure future maintainers can verify correctness.

Community Sustainability

1. **Open for Contribution:** Future students can expand grammar, add operators, or improve optimization.
2. **Academic Collaboration:** The tool can be adopted across courses for compiler-related instruction.
3. **Feedback Integration:** Students' classroom feedback can guide feature improvements.
4. **Knowledge Transfer:** Well-documented code ensures future batches can continue development.

Financial Sustainability

1. **Minimal Hosting Cost:** Only simple static hosting and a backend runtime are required.
2. **Academic Sponsorship:** Colleges can easily support its deployment.
3. **Grant Potential:** Educational software grants can support future upgrades.
4. **Community Support:** Contributions from students and developers can maintain longevity.

4.2 Project Management and Teamwork

The `CompilerSimulatorWeb` project followed an organized workflow to ensure efficiency, accuracy, and timely development.

Development Methodology

An agile approach was used:

- First iteration: Backend C compiler (lexer → parser → semantic → TAC → optimizer → assembly).
- Second iteration: Frontend UI in HTML/CSS.
- Third iteration: JavaScript integration with fetch API to communicate with backend.
- Final cycle: Testing, error handling refinement, styling, and documentation.

Task Distribution

Different development aspects were assigned to team members:

- **Backend C Compiler:** Lexical analyzer, parser, semantic checker, TAC generation, optimization, assembly generator.
- **Frontend Development:** index.html layout, style.css formatting, script.js logic.
- **Testing & QA:** Error handling, input validation, debug prints, sample case verification.
- **Integration:** Connecting JS fetch API with compiled C backend using Node.js or local execution.
- **Documentation:** Full report writing, code comments, user instructions.

Project Timeline

Phase	Description	Expected Completion Date
Planning	Design project structure, decide package layout, and plan GUI	11-Nov-2025
Implementation	Build GUI tabs, integrate core compiler modules	18-Nov-2025
Testing & Refinement	Test the compiler phases with multiple expressions, debug and fix issues	09-Dec-2026
Reporting	Prepare documentation, screenshots, and final report	14-Dec-2026

Project Team and Responsibilities – CompilerSimulatorWeb

Team Member	Role	Responsibilities
Shafin Ahmed (232-15-184)	Project Lead / Main Instructor / Lead Developer	Overall project supervision and technical leadership. Designed system architecture, implemented main compiler pipeline (compiler.c) integrated frontend with backend logic, handled error handling, guided to make all diagrams and guided team members.
MD Foyzal Bhuiyan (232-15-897)	Compiler Logic Developer	Developed core compiler modules including lexical analysis and syntax analysis. Assisted in implementing intermediate code generation.
Safayet Abir (232-15-225)	Frontend Developer / Code Integrator	Developed frontend components using HTML, CSS, JavaScript. Integrated visuals with backend compiler logic and contributed to error handling functionality.

Abu Dazana (232-15-810)	Documentation & Support Developer / Coder	Prepared project documentation, reports, and diagrams. Assisted in implementing semantic analysis and error handling modules.
Bijoy Krishna Sarker (232-15-219)	Testing, QA & Developer	Tested all modules, debugged code, ensured smooth functionality, and contributed to server.js and output visualization coding.

Communication Protocols

- Regular revision meetings
- Code reviews
- Testing logs and feedback cycles

Budget Analysis

- **Development Cost:** Zero (open-source tools).
- **Hosting Cost:** Minimal static hosting or local deployment.
- **Maintenance:** Only developer time for updates.
- **Revenue Model:** Non-commercial, educational purpose.

4.3 Complex Engineering Problem

4.3.1 Mapping of Program Outcome

TheCompilerSimulatorWeb – Stepwise Learning Tool for Compiler Phases project demonstrates achievement of multiple Program Outcomes (POs) as defined by engineering accreditation standards:

Table 4.1: Justification of Program Outcomes

PO's	Justification
PO1: Engineering Knowledge	Demonstrates strong understanding of compiler phases, algorithms, and data structures implemented in C.
PO2: Problem Analysis	Decomposing compiler design into six detailed phases and implementing each separately shows analytical capability.
PO3: Design/Development	Combining backend compiler logic with modern web technologies (HTML/CSS/JS) creates a practical educational system.
PO10: Individual and Teamwork	Requires communication, coordination, UI design clarity, and clear visualization of abstract compiler structures.

4.3.2 Complex Problem Solving

In this section, provide a mapping with problem solving categories. For each mapping add subsections to put rationale (Use Table 4.2).

Table 4.2: Mapping with Complex Problem Solving

CEP Attribute	Project Achievement (Based on CompilerSimulatorWeb Implementation)
EP1 – Depth of Knowledge	The project demonstrates a strong understanding of compiler design fundamentals, covering all six phases: lexical analysis, syntax analysis, semantic analysis, intermediate code generation, code optimization, and target code generation. The implementation shows clear knowledge of tokens, grammar rules, symbol tables, TAC generation, and assembly concepts .
EP2 – Range of Conflicting Requirements	The system balances multiple conflicting requirements such as <i>real-time processing vs. accuracy, visual clarity vs. performance, and browser limitations vs. backend compilation tools</i> . The design ensures smooth visualization while still managing complex compiler processes.
EP3 – Depth of Analysis	Each compiler phase has been deeply analyzed and implemented using actual algorithms (tokenization, recursive-descent parsing, semantic checks, TAC generation). The pipeline is structured, modular, and follows compiler construction principles.
EP4 – Familiarity of Issues	The project handles common compiler issues such as token errors, parse failures, undefined identifiers, and type mismatches. Error messages show awareness of typical debugging challenges in compiler design.
EP5 – Extent of Applicable Codes / Standards	The implementation follows programming best practices (modular JS backend , structured C-like grammar, clean abstraction of phases, proper error propagation). No external unnecessary standards were added—code remains aligned with classic compiler design guidelines taught in academia.
EP6 – Extent of Stakeholder Involvement	The tool is built for students, instructors, and learners . Features such as parse tree visualization, symbol table display, and color-coded tokens were incorporated specifically based on educational needs.

EP7 – Interdependence of Modules	Compiler phases are tightly interconnected: output of lexical feeds syntax, syntax feeds semantic, semantic feeds TAC, TAC feeds optimizer, optimizer feeds assembly. The project shows proper modular interdependence with clean flow across all stages .
---	---

Table 4.2: Mapping with complex problem solving.

EP1 Dept of Knowledge	EP2 Range of Conflicting Requirements	EP3 Depth of Analysis	EP4 Familiarity of Issues	EP5 Extent of Applicable Codes	EP6 Extent Of Stakeholder Involvement	EP7 Inter-dependence
✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

4.3.3 Complex Engineering Activities

The development of this project involved the following Complex Engineering Activities:

Table 4.3: Mapping with Complex Engineering Activities

EA Attribute	Project Achievement (Based on CompilerSimulatorWeb Implementation)
EA1 – Range of Resources	The project effectively uses a combination of web technologies (HTML, CSS, JavaScript), Node.js backend processing, and custom compiler-core modules. It also uses computational resources efficiently by running lexical, syntax, semantic, TAC, and assembly phases through JavaScript-based engine logic. No external compilers such as Flex/Bison were used, keeping the resource usage simple and manageable.
EA2 – Level of Interaction	The system provides highly interactive compiler visualizations, such as real-time token display, expandable parse trees, syntax/semantic tables, and immediate TAC/assembly generation. User interaction is continuous: typing, compiling, and viewing phase-by-phase results without page refresh.

EA3 – Innovation	The project showcases innovation through the integration of full compiler pipeline visualization in a browser environment. It transforms complex compiler phases into understandable visual components, making learning compiler design easier for students. The use of web-based parse trees, symbol tables, and TAC visualization is educationally unique.
EA4 – Consequences for Society and Environment	The project contributes positively to education by offering an accessible, web-based tool for teaching compiler design. No physical resources are used —everything operates digitally, reducing environmental impact. It supports self-learning and academic exploration for students without needing heavy software installations.
EA5 – Familiarity	The development relies on familiar and widely used technologies such as JavaScript, HTML/CSS, and Node.js. The compiler concepts implemented align with standard academic curricula , making the project both approachable and understandable for students and instructors.

Table 4.3: Mapping with Complex Engineering Activities

EA1 Range of resources	EA2 Level of Interactio n	EA3 Innovation	EA4 Consequences for society and environment	EA5 Familiarity
✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Chapter 5

Conclusion

This chapter summarizes the overall achievements of the **CompilerSimulatorWeb** project, identifies the limitations encountered during its development, and presents possible future enhancements and research directions based on the current system design and educational objectives.

5.1 Summary

The **CompilerSimulatorWeb** project successfully achieved its primary goal of developing a **web-based compiler simulation platform** that demonstrates all major phases of the compilation process in a clear and educational manner. The project focuses on transforming abstract compiler theory into an interactive and visual learning experience suitable for undergraduate computer science students.

This project implements a **complete compilation pipeline**, including lexical analysis, syntax analysis, semantic analysis, intermediate code generation (three-address code), basic code optimization, and target-level assembly code generation. Unlike traditional command-line compilers, **CompilerSimulatorWeb** emphasizes **step-by-step visualization**, allowing users to observe how source expressions are transformed internally during compilation.

The system integrates a **browser-based frontend** developed using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript with a structured compiler logic implemented using standard programming techniques. The clean separation between compilation phases and visualization components enhances clarity, maintainability, and educational value.

Overall, **CompilerSimulatorWeb** demonstrates that complex compiler concepts can be effectively taught through interactive web technologies, making the learning process more intuitive, engaging, and accessible.

5.2 Limitations

Despite the successful implementation of core compiler functionalities, several limitations were identified during the development and evaluation of the **CompilerSimulatorWeb** project.

Technical Limitations

Language Support Constraints

1. **Simplified Grammar:**

The compiler currently supports a limited grammar focused mainly on arithmetic expressions, assignments, and basic identifiers. More complex language constructs such as loops, conditionals, and functions are not included.

2. **Single Language Model:**
The system is designed around a single simplified language model (c) and does not support multiple programming languages.
3. **Limited Optimization Techniques:**
Only basic optimization strategies are implemented. Advanced optimizations such as loop unrolling, register allocation, and data-flow analysis are outside the current scope.

Performance Limitations

1. **Scalability Constraints:**
The system performs efficiently for small to medium-sized expressions, but performance may degrade when handling very large or deeply nested expressions.
2. **Visualization Overhead:**
Complex parse trees and large symbol tables can reduce responsiveness in the browser due to rendering limitations.
3. **Real-Time Processing Limits:**
Although real-time feedback is provided, extremely complex inputs may result in noticeable processing delays.

Architectural Limitations

1. **Extensibility Challenges:**
Extending the grammar or adding new language constructs requires manual modification of the compiler logic.
2. **Visualization Scaling:**
Displaying highly complex parse trees in a readable format remains challenging within limited screen space.
3. **Backend Execution Constraints:**
The current architecture is optimized for educational demonstration rather than industrial-scale compilation.

Educational Limitations

1. **Advanced Topics Coverage:**
Topics such as advanced compiler optimizations, parallel compilation, and formal language theory are not fully covered.
2. **Assessment Features:**
The system does not include built-in quizzes, grading, or student progress tracking mechanisms.
3. **Customization Options:**
Educators have limited ability to customize grammar rules or compiler behavior without modifying source code.

Error Handling Limitations

1. **Partial Phase Execution:**
When an invalid token or operator (e.g., `**`) is detected during lexical analysis, the compiler halts further phases and displays only partial output. Subsequent phases such as syntax, semantic analysis, and code generation are skipped.

2. **Limited Error Explanation:**
Error messages identify the location and reason of the error (e.g., invalid operator at a specific position) but do not provide corrective suggestions or alternative valid syntax.
3. **Single-Error Reporting:**
The system reports one error at a time. Multiple errors within the same expression are not detected or displayed together.
4. **Visualization Interruption:**
When an error occurs, visualization of later compilation stages is unavailable, limiting complete phase-wise learning for erroneous inputs.

5.3 Future Work

The CompilerSimulatorWeb project provides a strong foundation for future improvements and extended research opportunities.

Immediate Enhancement Opportunities

1. **Launching as a Website for free:**

Includes deploying CompilerSimulatorWeb as a publicly accessible website to allow wider student and instructor usage.
2. **Extended Grammar Support:**
Future versions of CompilerSimulatorWeb will include support for control structures such as conditional statements (if-else) and looping constructs (for, while) to better reflect real programming language behavior and improve practical learning outcomes.
3. **AI-Assisted Error Tolerance:**
Future enhancements may integrate AI-based logic to make the compiler more tolerant of common user mistakes. For example, the system could infer missing semicolons, ignore redundant operators by selecting the first valid operator, or suggest corrected expressions based on common error patterns.
4. **AI-Guided Expression Correction:**
An intelligent assistance module can analyze erroneous expressions and attempt compilation using the closest valid form of the input, while clearly indicating the corrections made. This feature would support beginners by reducing frustration and improving conceptual understanding.

Visualization Improvements

1. **Enhanced Parse Tree Rendering:**
Improve layout algorithms for better readability of complex trees.
2. **Animated Phase Transitions:**
Introduce animations to demonstrate transitions between compiler phases.
3. **Step-by-Step 6 Tab Execution Mode:**
Make 6 tabs for 6 phases for users which is more understandable..

User Experience Enhancements

1. **Guided Tutorials:**
Integrate interactive tutorials explaining each compiler phase.
2. **Practice Exercises:**
Provide built-in exercises for students to test their understanding.
3. **Responsive Design Improvements:**
Enhance usability on tablets and mobile devices.
4. **Collaborative Learning Features:**
Allow users to share expressions and results for group study.

Advanced Research Directions

1. **Intelligent Error Reporting:**
Develop an ai as a smarter error explanation that guides students toward correct solutions which is our nearest plan.
2. **Learning Analytics:**
Analyze user interactions to assess learning patterns and difficulties.
3. **Adaptive Learning Models:**
Adjust content complexity dynamically based on user performance.
4. **IDE Integration:**
Integrate visualization features into popular development environments.

Long-Term Vision

1. **Comprehensive Compiler Learning Platform:**
Expand the system into a full educational ecosystem including lessons, assessments.
2. **Academic Adoption:**
Promote usage across universities as a standard compiler teaching aid.
3. **Educational Research Foundation:**
Use the platform as a base for studying the effectiveness of visual learning in compiler education.

Conclusion

The **CompilerSimulatorWeb** project represents a meaningful contribution to compiler education by bridging the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical understanding. By visualizing every major compiler phase in a web-based environment, the project enhances comprehension, engagement, and learning efficiency. With further development and refinement, CompilerSimulatorWeb has the potential to evolve into a widely adopted educational platform for compiler construction and programming language studies.

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